

## Ἀλεξάνδρου τοῦ Μεγάλου Ἐπιστολαί

# Letters of Alexander the Great to Aristotle and Darius

eul\_aid: hgm

**Period:** *Κλασική* [Classical](#)

**Dialect:** *Κοινή* [Koine](#)

**Domain:** *Ἱστορία* [History](#)

**Format:** *Ἐπιστολή* [Epistle](#)

Alexander III of Macedon, known as Alexander the Great, was born in 356 BCE and died in 323 BCE. Tutored by Aristotle and the successor to his father, Philip II, he forged a vast empire stretching from Greece to the Indus Valley. A body of correspondence attributed to him, known as the Letters of Alexander the Great, exists. This epistolary corpus is pseudepigraphical, meaning it was composed by later authors rather than being contemporary historical documents from Alexander's own lifetime.

The extant collection is fragmentary, preserved within the works of later historians and through manuscript traditions. It comprises a set of pseudepigraphical letters and is not a single cohesive literary work.

This collection is a key example of ancient pseudepigrapha and forms part of the broader Alexander Romance tradition. The letters were composed between the 3rd century BCE and the 2nd century CE. They were used to lend authority to various narratives or to illustrate and define Alexander's character, thereby shaping his posthumous legendary image. Historians like Plutarch and Arrian used these sources cautiously. The corpus remains vital for understanding the literary construction of Alexander's myth throughout the Hellenistic, Roman, and medieval periods.

## Works (1)

- *Ἐπιστολαὶ πρὸς Ἀριστοτέλην καὶ Δαρεῖον* · [Letters to Aristotle and Darius](#) · 3 passages